

JORDAN RIVERA

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Platform engineer with 10+ years building resilient document-generation pipelines, layout engines, and developer-facing template systems. Specialised in high-throughput PDF rendering, semantic authoring DSLs, and turning brittle production-ops scripts into typed, snapshot-tested libraries that scale.

CORE SKILLS

- Languages: Java 21, Kotlin, Groovy, Python, SQL
- Document & Print: PDFBox, Apache POI (DOCX/XLSX), iText, PostScript, ICC colour profiles, font metrics
- Layout engines: Custom DSL design, semantic layout trees, pagination, snapshot testing, visual regression
- Build & infrastructure: Maven, Gradle, GitHub Actions, JitPack, Docker, JMH benchmarking
- Testing: JUnit 5, AssertJ, PDFBox-based PNG diff, layout-graph snapshots, mutation testing (Pitest)
- Distribution: Maven Central, Sonatype OSSRH, GPG signing, JitPack, semantic versioning discipline

EDUCATION

- MSc Computer Science - University of Manchester | 2021. Distinction. Thesis: Composable layout primitives for deterministic document rendering.
- BSc Software Engineering - Imperial College London | 2019. First-class honours. Specialisation in compilers and static analysis.
- Oracle Java Certification - Professional track | 2023. Java 17 platform deep-dive: records, sealed types, pattern matching, virtual threads.

EXPERIENCE

- Senior Platform Engineer, Northwind Systems | 2024-Present - Led the reusable document-generation platform serving billing, hiring, and reporting flows across 8 product teams. Reduced template maintenance time by 70% by retiring per-team PDF scripts in favour of one canonical engine.
- Software Engineer, BrightLeaf Labs | 2021-2024 - Built backend services and production document rendering pipelines processing 2M+ documents per month. Drove the migration from iText to a custom layout engine, eliminating licensing risk and cutting p99 render latency from 1.4s to 380ms.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- GraphCompose - Declarative Java PDF layout engine. Semantic DSL, slot-based templates, snapshot testing. Powers production CV / invoice / proposal pipelines for hiring tools and billing systems. (Open source)
- Template Studio - Internal tool for evaluating CV, proposal, and invoice output across 14 design presets. PNG diffing, side-by-side layout, baseline freezing.
- LayoutLint - Static analyser that flags fragile authoring patterns (deeply nested rows, untyped offsets, implicit page breaks) before they ship to production.

EXPERIENCE

- Senior Platform Engineer, Northwind Systems

2024-Present

Led the reusable document-generation platform serving billing, hiring, and reporting flows across 8 product teams. Reduced template maintenance time by 70% by retiring per-team PDF scripts in favour of one canonical engine.
- Software Engineer, BrightLeaf Labs

2021-2024

Built backend services and production document rendering pipelines processing 2M+ documents per month. Drove the migration from iText to a custom layout engine, eliminating licensing risk and cutting p99 render latency from 1.4s to 380ms.
- Backend Engineer, Helix Print Co

2019-2021

Maintained a high-volume invoice-printing service (15M PDFs/year) and authored the compliance test harness that gated every template change.

PROJECTS

- GraphCompose - Declarative Java PDF layout engine. Semantic DSL, slot-based templates, snapshot testing. Powers production CV / invoice / proposal pipelines for hiring tools and billing systems. (Open source)
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- LayoutLint - Static analyser that flags fragile authoring patterns (deeply nested rows, untyped offsets, implicit page breaks) before they ship to production.
- ChromeForge - Editorial-magazine document toolkit built on GraphCompose: cinematic covers, pull quotes, multi-column flow, sidebar callouts.

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ADDITIONAL

- Languages: English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), Spanish (Basic)
- Work Eligibility: Eligible to work in the UK and the EU
- Open Source: Maintainer of GraphCompose. Regular contributor to PDFBox issue triage.
- Speaking: JVM Summit 2024, Devovx UK 2025 — both on declarative document layout.